

Old Testament (Septuagint) reading list

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<http://www.orthodox.net/articles/old-testament-reading-list.docx>

<http://www.orthodox.net/articles/old-testament-reading-list.pdf>

Read daily: Psalms.

When I say "read," I mean "pray." Chant the psalms, aloud or "in your head" every day. /I advise adding the psalter to your morning or evening prayers. It is best to get a Psalter and to read it in Kathismas, or in sections of a Kathisma. A Kathisma is a division of Psalms from the beginning to the end. There are 20. We can think of them as chapters. Within each Kathisma are three sub-chapters, which we call a stasis.

It is useful to read a full Kathisma every day or perhaps just a stasis or even one psalm. You should try to read through the entire Psalter as frequently as you can. I recommend that you begin with Psalm 1, read what you wish, and then the next day, take up where you left off. And do this every day, for the rest of your life.

Read the Prophetologion

The best way to get acquainted with the books of the Old Testament is to read the sections the church considers to be very important. If you get something called a Prophetologion, which is easily available on the internet for a small price, you will see all of the Old Testament readings that are used for various feast days of saints, the great feasts of the Lord, and the Theotokos, Great Lent readings, etc. If you read these readings in the context of when they're being read you start to understand what they mean. An example is a reading for a feast of the Theotokos. There is a selection from Ezekiel, talking about a gate that is shut, and in the context of the Theotokos, this is referring to her perpetual virginity.

We use this book in our church services. It is excellent, and its language is excellent. It uses liturgical English. It is well-organized and complete. And it's only 40 bucks, a worthy investment. My only complaint about it is that there is not an e-version so I can't put it on my Kindle and easily take notes.

<https://www.lulu.com/shop/rdr-peter-gardner-ed/the-prophetologion/hardcover/product-21776016.html?page=1&pageSize=4>

If you want to read online or in your Kindle you can get a version that is a PDF, that is unfortunately in common English, I call it "Yoo-hoo" language ("There are sometimes constructs like, O lord, you, who... ") It certainly doesn't move me but many people are just fine with it. Fortunately, those people are not the ones who decide what gets read in my church services! You may want to download this and read it on your computer or on your Kindle. It is very complete just like the paper Prophetologion, which I prefer.

Prophetologion | Almoutran

<https://almoutran.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/08/FINAL-07-28-2012-BDK-Prophetologion.pdf>

I used an online converter to convert the PDF to EPUB format so I could load it to my kindle. It's a little squirrely looking but it's intact and it makes it easy for me to take notes. Those notes are usually transformed into videos or sermons or articles.

During Great Lent, read the “Lenten Lectionary” daily

During Great Lent, we read a selection from Genesis, Isaiah, and Proverbs, every day. You will be very edified if you keep up with this discipline. I have put this online. You can download it and put it on your Kindle (or Kindle app, which I use on a notepad and my PC), print it, or read it on your computer. Or you can read the “Prophetologion”, referenced elsewhere in this letter. I much prefer reading all the troparia and prokeimena with the readings. They are very edifying, so much so that I also read the troparia separately. Here are links.

<https://www.orthodox.net/greatlent/lectionary.html>

- [Lenten Lectionary for the First Week of Great Lent](#)

Clean Monday through the First Sunday of Great Lent

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

- [Lenten Lectionary for the Second Week of Great Lent](#)

The 2nd Monday through the Sunday of St Gregory Palamas

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

- [Lenten Lectionary for the Third Week of Great Lent](#)

The 3rd Monday through the Sunday of the Adoration of the Precious Cross

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

- [Lenten Lectionary for the Fourth Week of Great Lent](#)

The 4th Monday through the Sunday of St John Climacus

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

- [Lenten Lectionary for the Fifth Week of Great Lent](#)

The 5th Monday through the Sunday of St May of Egypt

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

- [Lenten Lectionary for the Sixth Week of Great Lent](#)

The 6th Monday through Palm Sunday

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

- [Lenten Lectionary for Holy Week](#)

Holy Monday through Holy Saturday

Other Formats: [RTF](#) [PDF](#)

Lenten Lectionary – Troparion of the Prophecy at the Sixth Hour

Large print:

<http://www.orthodox.net/greatlent/lenen-lectionary-troparion-of-the-prophecy.docx>

<http://www.orthodox.net/greatlent/lenen-lectionary-troparion-of-the-prophecy.pdf>

Booklet. Print this in a duplexing printer, on both sides, in “landscape” mode, flipping the page on the short end. You will have a convenient booklet, that is very easy to read. If you have a “saddle stapler”, you can easily staple it. I have made thousands of booklets.

<http://www.orthodox.net/greatlent/lenen-lectionary-troparion-of-the-prophecy-booklet.pdf>

Read these often, over and over:

Proverbs

Ecclesiastes

Wisdom

Sirach

Susanna, the first chapter of Daniel

Jonas (Jonah)

Ruth

Esther

I read all of the above in rotation. Generally, I'm reading two or three or even five of them at once and reading a chapter from each or sometimes two chapters from one and none from the others, etc.

We should always be reading these books because they are amazing. They have wonderful stories in them and wonderful wisdom that is more easy to acquire than the theology and wisdom that is in the prophets.

You might want to add Job to this list. Job is an amazing book but for me it's always been kind of a little thick and tiring. You might love it and you might add it to your rotation. I certainly read Job more than once throughout the year.

Of these books, my favorites are definitely Wisdom of Solomon and Sirach. All the other ones are fantastic as well, but I go back to those books all the time, and I'm constantly reading them. You can find amazing references to the Incarnation in them and everyday wisdom that is applicable to your daily life.

You can find wisdom in all of the Old Testament books and, for that matter, any book of the Bible; however, many of them require a knowledge of history and of the prevailing culture and other such things in order for you to be able to glean knowledge. You can read a chapter of Wisdom or Proverbs or Sirach without knowing any of those things and pick up something that is very useful for your soul.

Remember, you are reading this stuff because you want to change. You want to have something that teaches you how to live, what's right with you, what's wrong with you, and things that touch your heart in a way that helps you to change the way you live.

Read these occasionally:

Genesis, Exodus,
Tobit,
Job

Read all the above books first (and often) and continue to be reading them, then mix in these books

Shown in order of the table of contents:

Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, Joshua, Judges,
Kings I, Kings II, Kings III, Kings IV, Chronicles I, Chronicles II, Ezra, I Esdras, Nehemiah, Judith
I Maccabees, II Maccabees, III Maccabees, IV Maccabees,
Song of Songs,
Esaias, Jeremias, Lamentations, Baruch, Jezekeiel, Daniel, Osee, Joel, Amos, Obdias, ,
Michaeas, Naum, Ambacum, Sophonias, Aggaeus, Zacharias, Malachias

Full Septuagint Table of Contents:

Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Kings I, Kings II, Kings III, Kings IV, Chronicles I, Chronicles II, Ezra, I Esdras, Nehemiah, Tobit, Judith, Esther, I Maccabees, II Maccabees, III Maccabees, IV Maccabees, Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs, Wisdom, Sirach, Esaias, Jeremias, Lamentations, Baruch, Jezekiel, Daniel, Osee, Joel, Amos, Obdias, Jonas, Michaeas, Naum, Ambacum, Sophonias, Aggaeus, Zacharias, Malachias